

by the tumour in the form of unbridled to what is said to them by way of they listen, as they treat it with contempt phant closing his eyes (and remaining sses around), they pain their teachers advice. The kingly nature is always by the swoon caused by the burning fever duce the delirium in the form of false uces a coma brought on by the working er.

bent on doing what is good, consider (i.e. of wealth) herself first. This Lakshmī, portively moving about in the lotus-bed f brave warriors, (first) arose from the i her these mementos to lighten (the ount of her fondness for them due to : (she brought) *rāga* (passion) from tree (which possess *ragā*—redness); ess) from the crescent-moon (which); *chanchalatā* (unsteadiness) from (the possesses *chāñchalatā*—fleetness); the) from (the deadly poison) Kālakūta of *mohana*—causing swoon); *mada* possesses *mada*—drunkenness); and) from the Kaustubha gem (which ss). There is nothing else in this f (the tie of) familiarity (i. e. friend- tshmī). (For) even when obtained, culty. Though made fast (secure) merits, she vanishes. Even when cage (i. e. cage-like array) of the ed (wielded) by thousands of) warriors, she escapes. Though se columns of elephants darkened rut-water, she slips away. She miliarity; regards not noble birth; respect for hereditary connexion; virtue; counts (minds) not ear for learning; regards not ificence; takes no heed of discri- tinguish merit from demerit);

observes not customary duties; takes no account of truth; and she sets no value upon (a person's possessing) auspicious marks. Like the outline of the city of the Gandharvas¹ she vanishes just as one is looking at her. She wanders about (i. e. from person to person) as though she is still under the influence of the giddy sensation caused by her being whirled round in the whirl-pool made by the turnings of the Mandara mountain. She nowhere plants her foot firmly, as though a thorn from a lotus-stalk were run into it on account of her roamings in lotus-beds. Even when held firmly with very great efforts, in the palaces of great kings, she reels aside, (goes away) as if intoxicated by drinking wine (i. e. ichor) from the temples of numerous scent-elephants. She dwells (i. e., depends for stability) on the edges of swords, as if to learn *pārushya* (cruelty) (from them which possess *pārushya*—keenness). She clings to (the chest-region of) the body of Nārāyaṇa, as if to learn *vis'varūpatva* (presenting all kinds of illusory appearances) (from him, who possesses *visvarupatva*—the state of having the whole universe contained in his form). Full of apprehension (*lit.*, having no confidence for the most part in one), she leaves a king, even though he may have well enriched (made good additions) to his inherited territory, his army, his treasury, and the number of princes subordinate unto him, as she does a lotus at the close of the day although it may have a well developed root, stalk and its circular pericarp. Like a creeper which climbs branches of trees, she dwells with persons who patronize parasites (voluptuous persons). Like Gaṅgā who although she gave birth to the (eight) Vasus is restless with her ripples and bubbles, she, although the producer of wealth, is yet as fickle as the bubbles of waves. Like the movement of the sun which exhibits the various stages of his passage from one zodiacal sign to another, she exhibits her own fitting movements (from one person to another). Like a cave of the Nether Regions which is full of darkness, she is full of dark deeds. Like (the demoness) Hidimbā whose heart was captivated solely by the daring deeds of Bhīma, she is one whose heart can be attracted only by deeds of stupendous daring. Like the rainy season which produces lightning, she produces a short-lived glow (display of prosperity). Like a wicked she-goblin who

¹ The phantom of a city in the sky due to some meteorological cause, called.

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shows her height as measuring (equal to) that of several men (standing one over another) and drives a timid man into frenzy. She shows (successively) the elevation (rise to prosperity) of many (different) persons, and crazes a weak-minded person (or, makes him drunk with pride). As if out of jealousy, she embraces not a person who is favoured by Sarasvatī (the goddess of learning). She touches not a virtuous person, as if he were unholy. She does not think highly of a noble-minded person, as if he were something inauspicious. She does not (even) look at a good man, as at an evil omen. She passes over (avoids) a high-born person, as at a snake. She shuns a brave person, as if he were a thorn (in her way). She does not remember (forgets to approach) a liberal man, as if he were an evil dream. She approaches not an educated person, as if he were a sinner. She mocks at a noble-minded person, as if he were a drunkard. And in this world she manifests her actions, as if she were exhibiting a juggler's tricks which (on their face) appear to be opposed to each other. For example:—Though always producing heat, she creates cold.¹ Though bestowing height she exhibits stuntedness.² Though sprung from the store of water, she increases thirst.³ Though she transforms one into Śiva, still she displays a nature that is not of Śiva.⁴ Though she increases one's strength, still she brings on lightness (loss of weight).⁵ Though she is sister of (produced from the same place as) nearar (which is sweet), still she gives rise to a bitter taste.⁶ Though she possesses a body,⁷ still her actual sight is invisible to the senses. Though attached to the best men, still she loves wicked persons.⁸

¹ The real sense is—'she keeps a man in good spirits, and yet makes him dull'.

² Real sense—'brings about an elevation of rank or position, and yet gives rise to meanness of character'.

³ Real sense—'she is born of the Ocean, and she increases one's avarice'.

⁴ Real sense—'she makes a man wealthy, and leads to vileness of character'.

⁵ Real sense—'she makes him highly powerful, and makes him weak-minded'.

⁶ Real sense—'she brings disasters in her train'.

⁷ Real sense—'she is full of (fosters) stife'. अस्वर्ग्यता may mean in the second case—makes a person long for things not actually within sight (reach)'.
⁸ Real sense—'she is attached to Viśṇu, and she loves (favours) wicked persons'.

As if made of dust she soils even the pure.¹ And the more this fickle one blazes forth (makes a man more and more prosperous) the more does she give rise to actions, dark like lampblack, alone, just as the more the flickering flame of a lamp burns, the more does it produce black soot, (and nothing else). It is thus:—She acts as the nourishing stream of water to the poisonous creepers in the form of (evil) desires; as the song of a hunter to (for luring away) the deer in the form of the senses; as the obscuring line of smoke to the pictures in the form of good actions; as a luxurious bed to the long sleep of infatuation; as an old terrace for residence to the she-goblins in the form of pride of wealth; as the appearance of timira (opacity of the cornea) to the eyes in the form of the Ś 5 ras; as the banner borne in the van to all deeds of insolence; as the native river to the alligators in the form of the out-bursts of violence; as the drinking ground to the wines in the form of pleasures; as the music-hall to the gestures in the form of the knittings of the eye-brows; as the residence-cavern (lair) to the pythons in the form of faults; as the cane-staff (for driving away people), to the words (of advice) of good men; as the untimely (setting in of the) rains, to the swans in the form of merits; as the (favourable) surface for spreading, to the tumours in the form of public scandals; as the prologue, to the drama in the form of deception; as the banner to (on the head of) the elephant in the form of lust; as the slaughter-house, to good intentions; and as the (eclipsing) tongue of Rahu to the orb of the moon in the form of righteousness. And I do not see anyone who has not been (suddenly) very closely embraced by her though not familiar with him, and then deceived. Surely she will move away (i.e., leave a person), even when consigned to a picture (i.e., visualized mentally as sure of attainment); will produce illusions like magic, even when confined to books (i.e., made as steady as matter committed to books); she will deceive, even when (merely) engraved as a statue (in one's mind, i.e., when means be conceived to remove short-comings and make her steady); will cheat, even when (merely) heard of; and will take one in, even when (merely) thought about (leads men to seek her but they find her not).

And when in obedience to the will of destiny, kings are somehow favoured by her, who is of this description and behaves so

¹ Real sense—'she makes even an honest person dishonest (or, warps the judgment of a man of pure thought)'.
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ill, they become helpless and come to be the abode of all evil deeds.

Thus:—At the very time of their coronation, their country is washed away, as if with the water (poured on them) from auspicious jars; their heart becomes darkened (unfeeling), as if with the smoke of the sacrifices offered to Fire; their forgiveness is swept away, as if with the brooms in the form of the tips of the *kusa* grass held by the priests (in their hands); their remembrance of (the thought about) the approach of old age is covered over, *i.e.*, forgotten), as if with the folding of cloth of the turbans (head-dresses); the sight of the next world is hidden (from them), as if with the large, circular umbrella (held over their heads); their truthfulness is blown away, as if with the breezes of the *chowries* (waved around them); their merits are driven away, as if with the cane-staffs (of the door-keepers); good words (of advice) are prevented from being heard (drowned), as if by the din of the cries of victory; and glory is blotted off, as if by the streamers of the banner-cloths. And also:—Some kings come to be miserable-being tempted by riches, which are as unsteady as the hollow neck of a bird hanging loose through exhaustion, which look charming for a short while only like the flash of a fire-fly, and which are condemned by (all) high-minded persons; having forgotten their (real condition as) birth owing to the arrogance caused by the acquisition of a little wealth; being affected by vehemence of passion increased by various misdeeds, as by corrupt blood full of various impurities; being harassed by their senses, which, although only five, appear to number many thousands as it were, in their eagerness to taste the various (sensual) pleasures; and being distracted by their mind, which although but one appears to have been multiplied

(guided in their course of action) by others, like lame persons, who are unable to walk (by themselves). They (condescend to) speak with great difficulty, as though suffering from ulcers in the mouths, as a result of telling falsehoods. By (their glances which are) the results of the operation of the quality of *rajās* (passion) as if due to the eye disease called *kasuma*, they produce a headache in those who move near them, like the *Saptachhadā* trees (causing headache) by the operation of the pollen of their blossoms. Like people about to die, they do not recognize even their relatives. Like persons with sore eyes who cannot look at bright objects, they cannot (bear to) look at men of spirit. As persons bitten by (deadly) black snakes cannot be restored to life even by means of mighty spells, they cannot be roused (into activity) even by means of excellent counsels. Like ornaments made of lac, which are unable to bear (the presence of) hot objects, they cannot bear spirited persons (near them). Being rendered insensible by the apathy due to their great pride, they do not listen to advice, as mad elephants made fast at their very large tying-posts (do not listen to the directions of their drivers). As persons fainting under the influence of thirst-like poison see everything golden, they, rendered insensible by the poison of greed, see all things as made of gold. Just as arrows, with sharpness increased by being whetted on a stone, destroy when discharged by the enemy, so they, whose cruelty is increased by drinking liquor, destroy (persons) at the instigation of others. By sending their armies they annihilate great families, although they stand far away from them (*i.e.*, do not molest them in any way), just as men fell down fruit, though growing high in a tree, by throwing sticks at them. Though charming in

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